

CONTACT INFORMATION	Isenberg School of Management University of Massachusetts Amherst 121 Presidents Drive, Amherst, MA 01003	Email: xiaoyuzhao@umass.edu Phone: +1 (413) 416-0966 Website: sites.google.com/view/txzhaio
EDUCATION	Finance Ph.D. Finance Master (with Distinction) Economics Bachelor	University of Massachusetts Amherst 2021–2027 (expected) Hong Kong Polytechnic University Nankai University
RESEARCH INTEREST	Hedge Funds, Institutional Investors, Geopolitical Risk, Options, Fintech, Cybersecurity	
WORKING PAPERS	Hedge Fund Performance and the U.S.–China Tension (solo-authored) <i>Presentations:</i> SoFiE Annual Conference 2026,Frontiers of Factor Investing Conference 2026 (Lancaster), SWFA Annual Conference 2026, EFA Annual Conference 2026, SHKDI Conference 2026 (CUHK), IFMB Conference 2026 (Nottingham Trent), Volatility Institute Conference 2025 (NYU-Shanghai), Boca Finance and Real Estate Conference 2025 (FAU) Informed Option Trading and Cybersecurity Events (solo-authored) <i>Presentations:</i> World Finance & Banking Symposium 2025, INFORMS Annual Meeting 2025, UMass Amherst Isenberg Brownbag (2024) (scheduled *)	
WORK IN PROGRESS	Institutional Investor and Section-301 Tariffs PCAOB and US-listed Chinese Stocks	
TEACHING	Instructor, Isenberg School of Management Financial Modeling (FIN304) Fall 2023 (4.7/5.0), Spring 2024 (4.8/5.0), Spring 2025 (4.5/5.0) Fall 2025 (online, 5.0/5.0) International Finance (FIN405) Fall 2024 (4.7/5.0)	2023–2026
	Substitute Instructor, Isenberg School of Management Topics in Financial Technology (FIN408) Financial Engineering (FIN422)	2026
	Teaching Assistant, Isenberg School of Management Advanced Corporate Finance (Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2023) Corporate Finance (Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023) Fundamental Principles of Financial Management (Spring 2023)	2021–2023

CONFERENCES	SoFiE Annual Conference [†]	2026
	5 th Frontiers of Factor Investing Conference (Lancaster) [†]	2026
	SWFA Annual Conference ^{†‡}	2026
	EFA Annual Conference ^{†‡}	2026
	20 th SHKDI Conference (CUHK) [†]	2026
	4 th IFMB Conference (Nottingham Trent) ^{†‡}	2026
	14 th World Finance & Banking Symposium [†]	2025
	10 th Annual Volatility Institute Conference (NYU-Shanghai) [†]	2025
	2 nd Annual Boca Finance and Real Estate Conference (FAU) ^{†‡}	2025
	INFORMS Annual Meeting [†]	2025
	FMA Annual Meeting [‡]	2025
	<i>(presenting †, discussant ‡, scheduled *)</i>	
AWARDS AND HONORS	UMass Amherst GSG Research & Travel Grant	2026
	Isenberg School of Management Doctorate Fellowship	2021–2025
	Isenberg School of Management PhD Program Travel Grant	2025–2026
	Isenberg School of Management Dissertation Proposal Fellowship	2025
	Outstanding Academic Achievement Award, Hong Kong PolyU	2018
MEMBERSHIPS	Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA [®]) Charterholder	
	American Finance Association (AFA)	
	Financial Management Association (FMA)	
	Eastern Finance Association (EFA)	
NON-ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE	China Financial Services Holdings Limited	2018–2021
	<i>Investment Manager</i>	<i>Hong Kong</i>
	Bank of Beijing Group	
	<i>Financing Manager</i>	<i>Beijing</i>
	Xiamen International Bank	
	<i>Account Manager (Financial Institutions)</i>	<i>Beijing</i>
SKILLS	R, Stata, SAS (SQL), Python, WRDS, L ^A T _E X	
LANGUAGES	English (Fluent); Mandarin (Native); Cantonese (Fluent)	
REFERENCES	Prof. Bing Liang (Committee co-chair) Finance Department Isenberg School of Management University of Massachusetts Amherst bliang@isenberg.umass.edu	Prof. Marco Macchiavelli (Committee co-chair) Finance Department Isenberg School of Management University of Massachusetts Amherst mmacchiavelli@isenberg.umass.edu
	Prof. John Spraggon (External Committee Member) Department of Resource Economics College of Social & Behavioral Sciences University of Massachusetts Amherst jmspragg@resecon.umass.edu	Prof. Fousseni Chabi-Yo (Chair of Finance Department) Finance Department Isenberg School of Management University of Massachusetts Amherst fchabiyo@isenberg.umass.edu